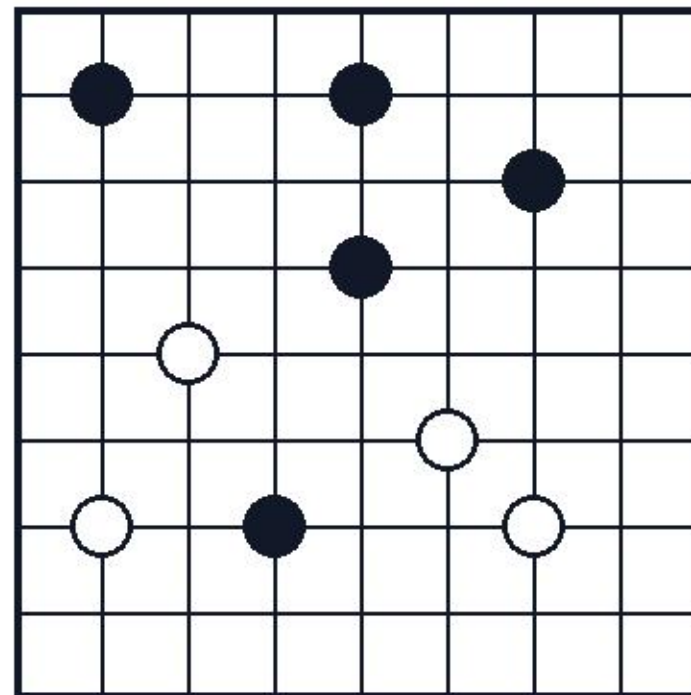
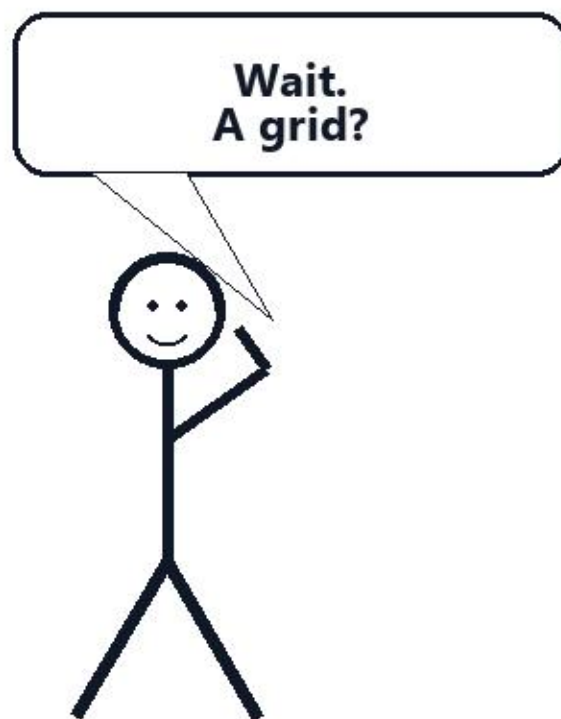
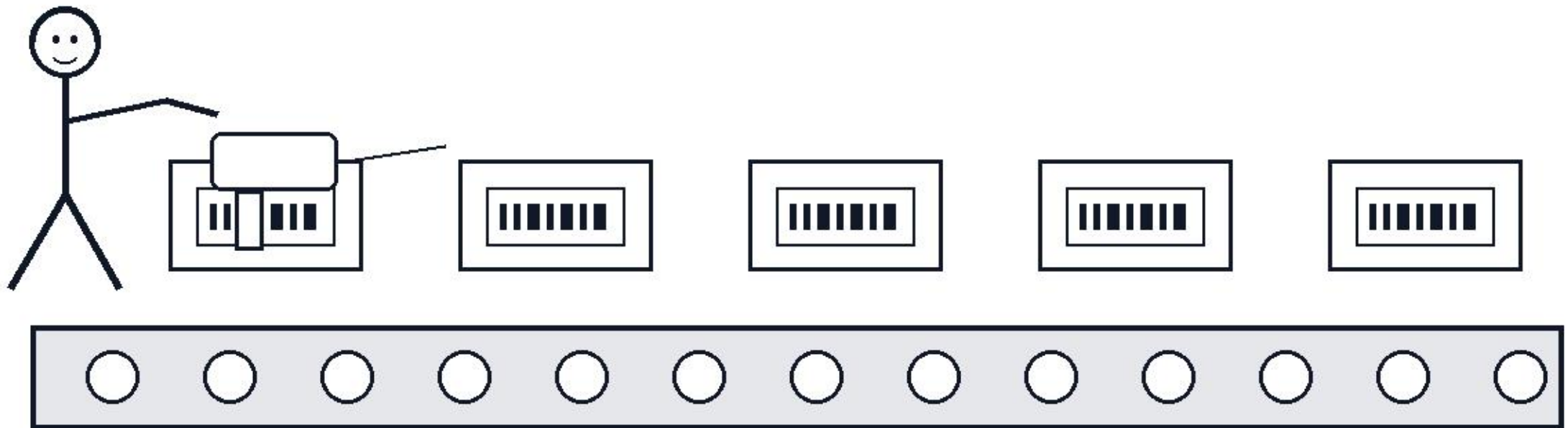


Was the QR code invented during lunch?



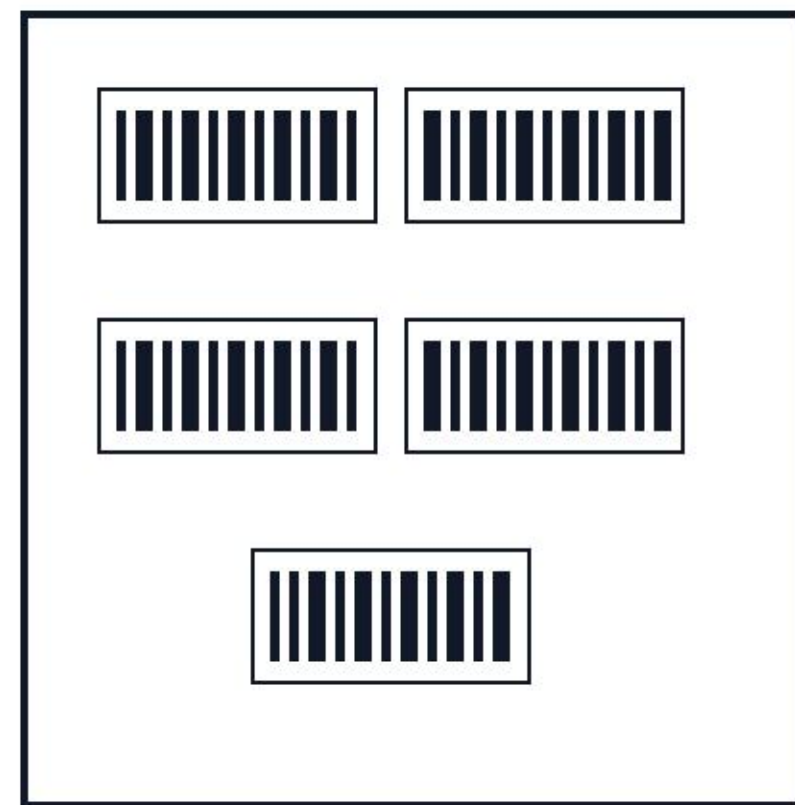
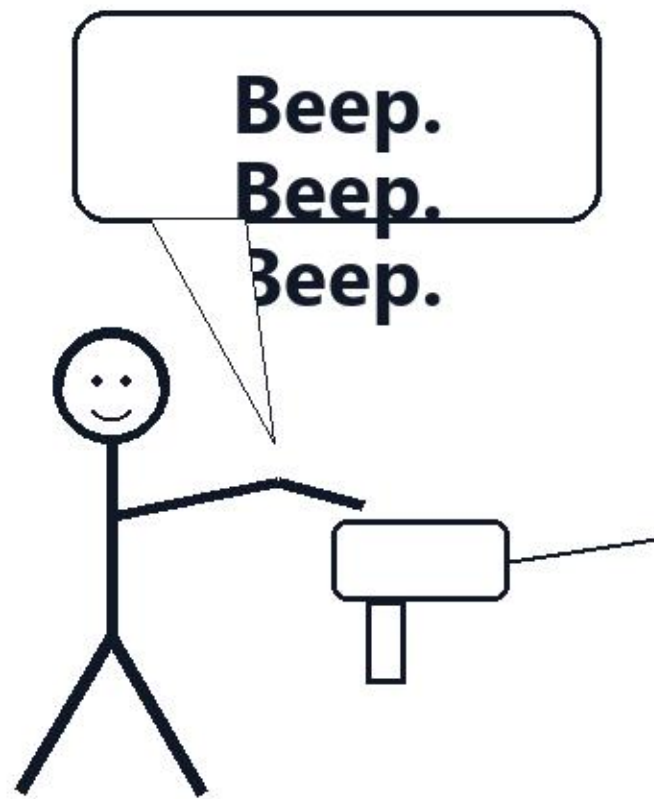
**The short answer: not entirely.
But the lunch break mattered.**

Before menus and payment links, there was a factory problem.



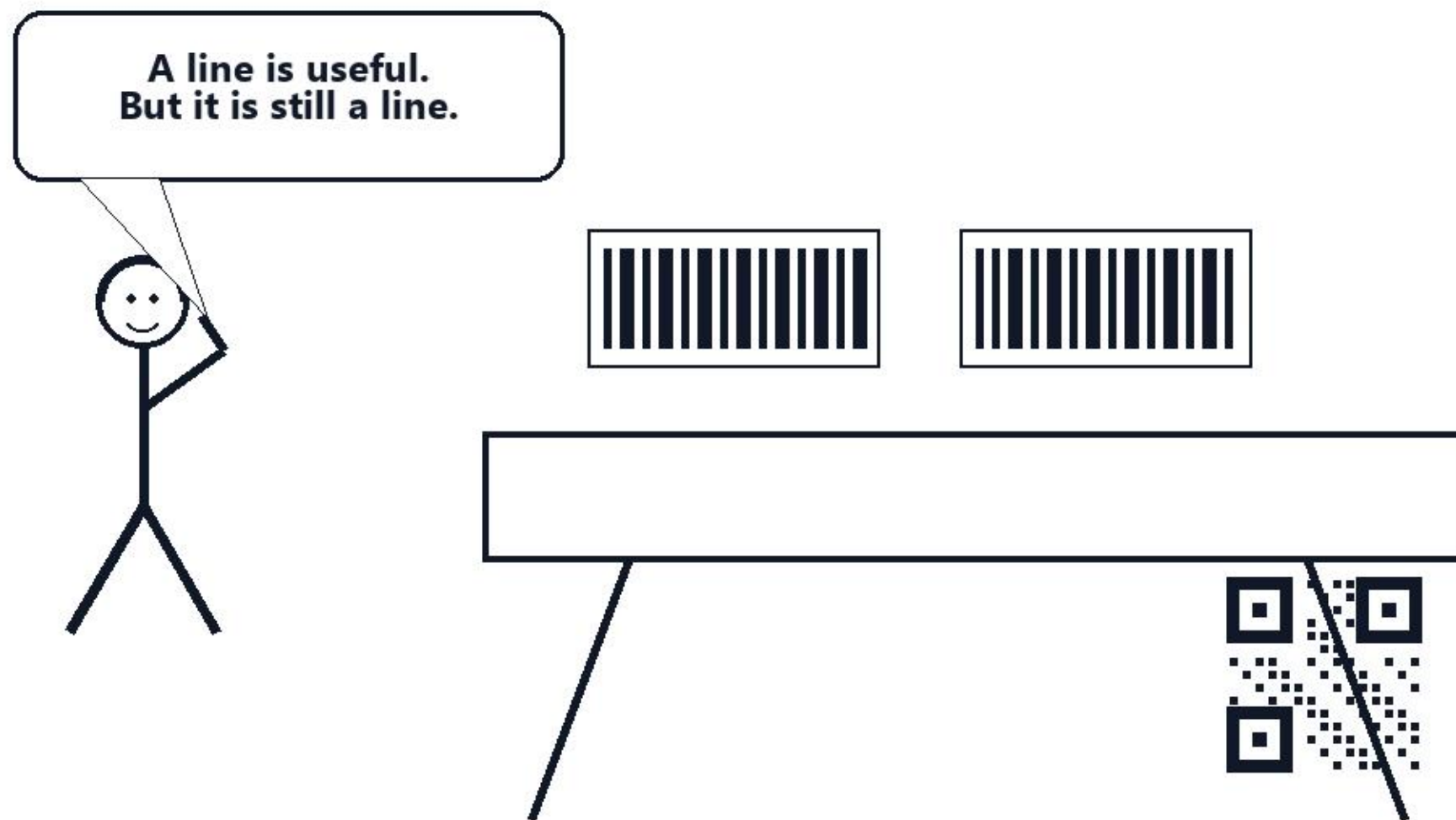
QR codes were a solution to a factory irritation.

**Too many parts.
Too many labels.
Too many scans.**



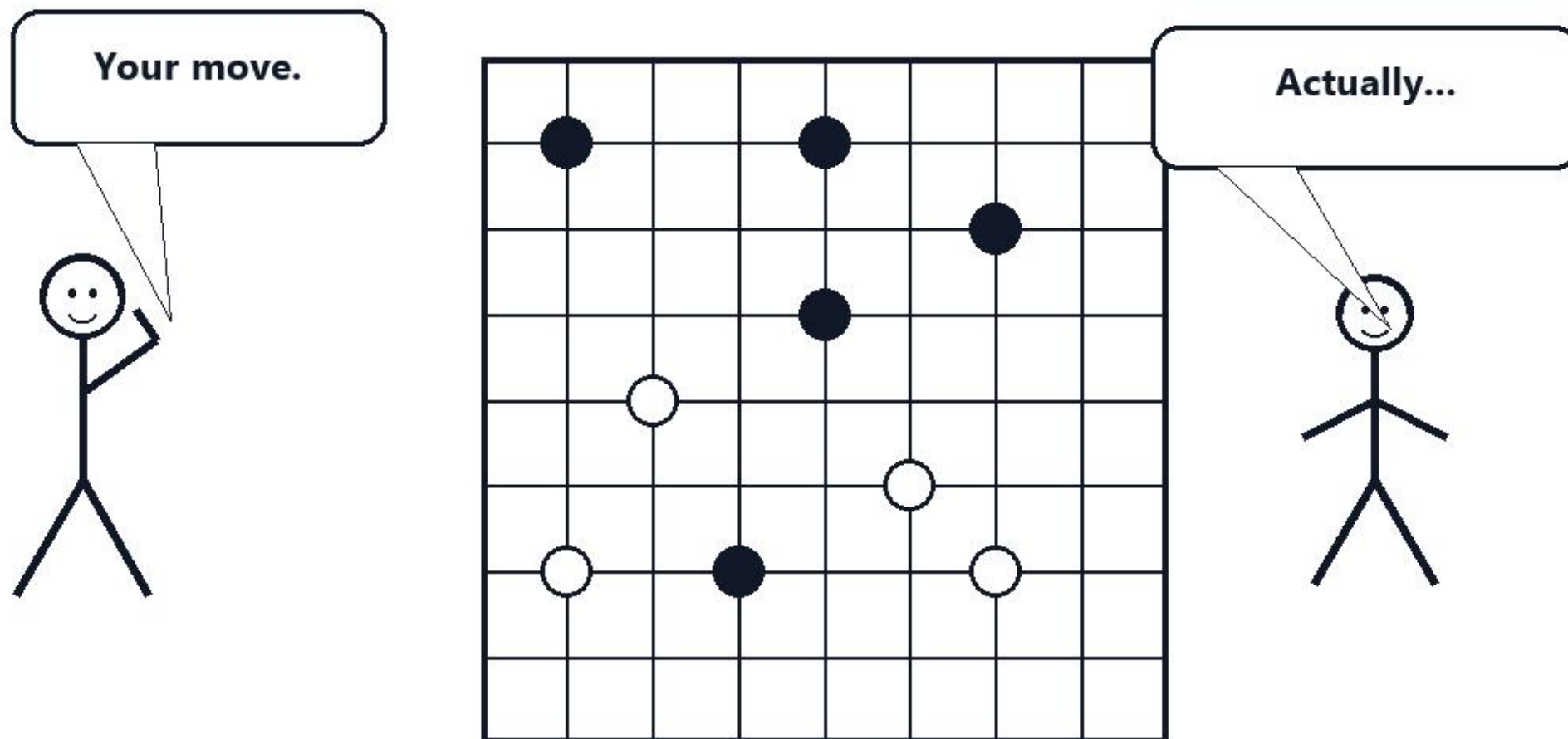
**A single box could require multiple barcode scans.
That is friction you can hear.**

Masahiro Hara knew barcodes were running out of road.



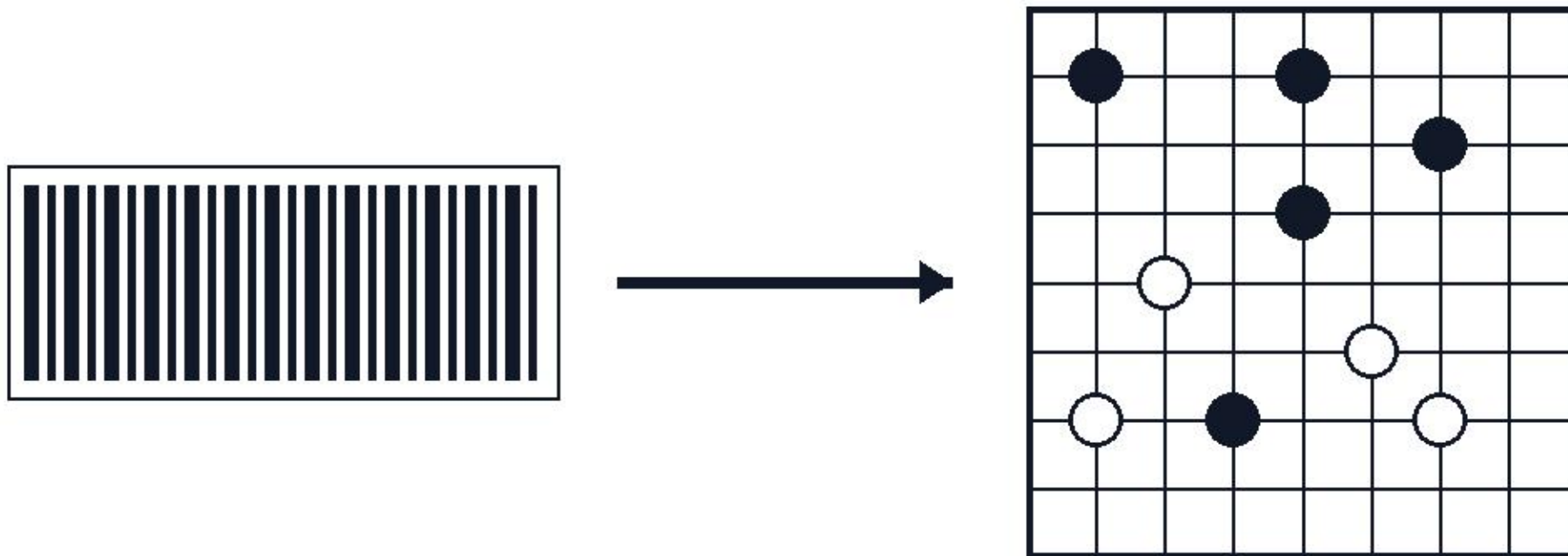
Hara had worked on scanners and recognition systems.
He understood the limits from inside the machine.

Then came lunch. And a Go board.



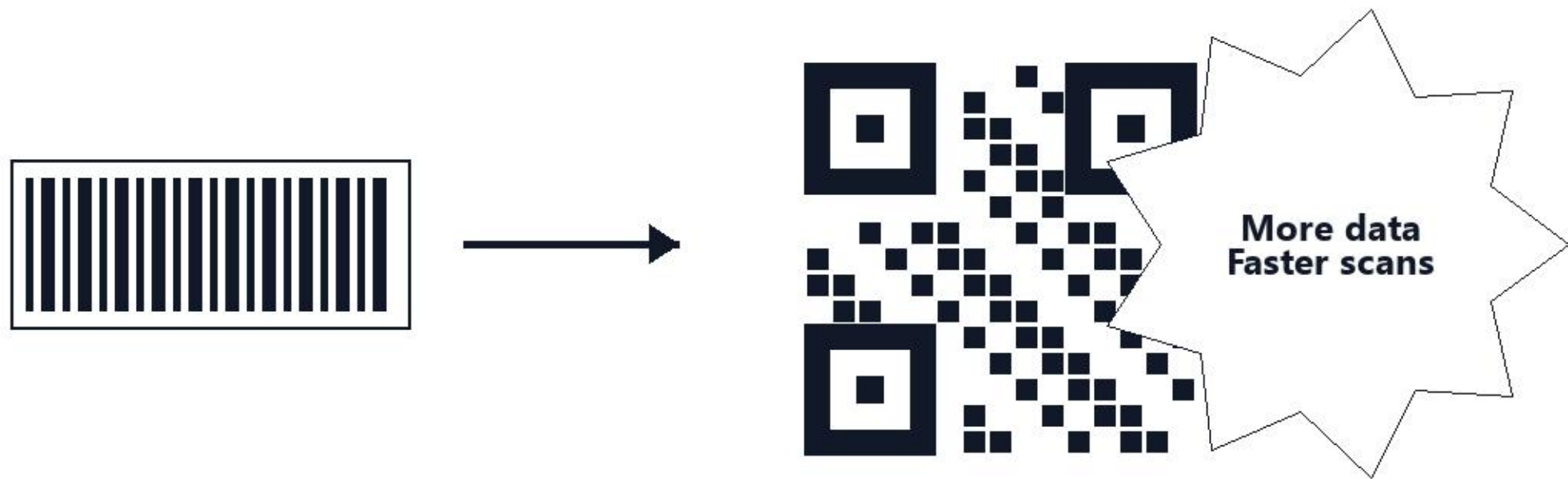
**Black stones. White stones. A grid.
A different way to think about information.**

**A barcode is a line.
A Go board is a grid.**



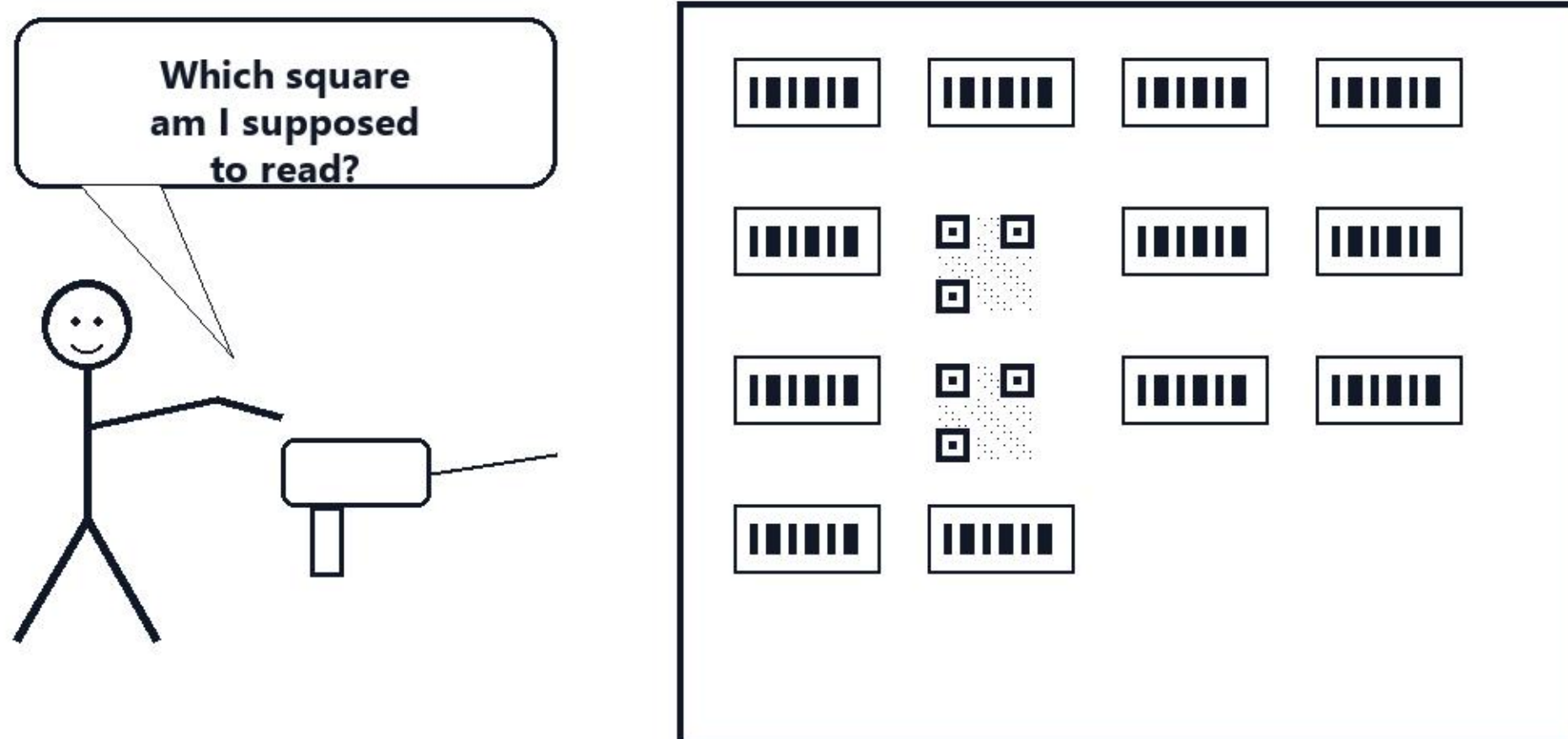
**The mental shift was simple but powerful:
stop thinking only left-to-right.**

What if information lived in two dimensions?



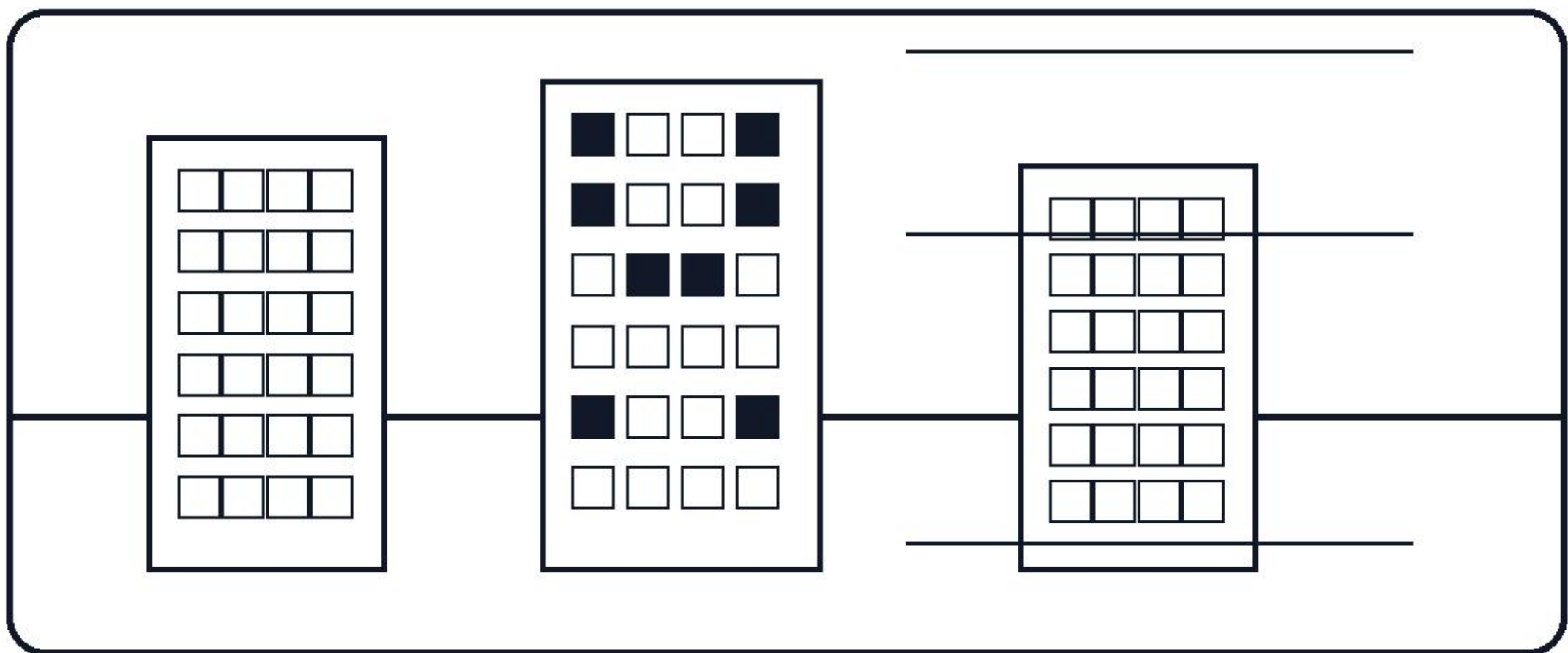
**That was the QR idea: information across and down,
not just along one line.**

But now the scanner had a new problem.



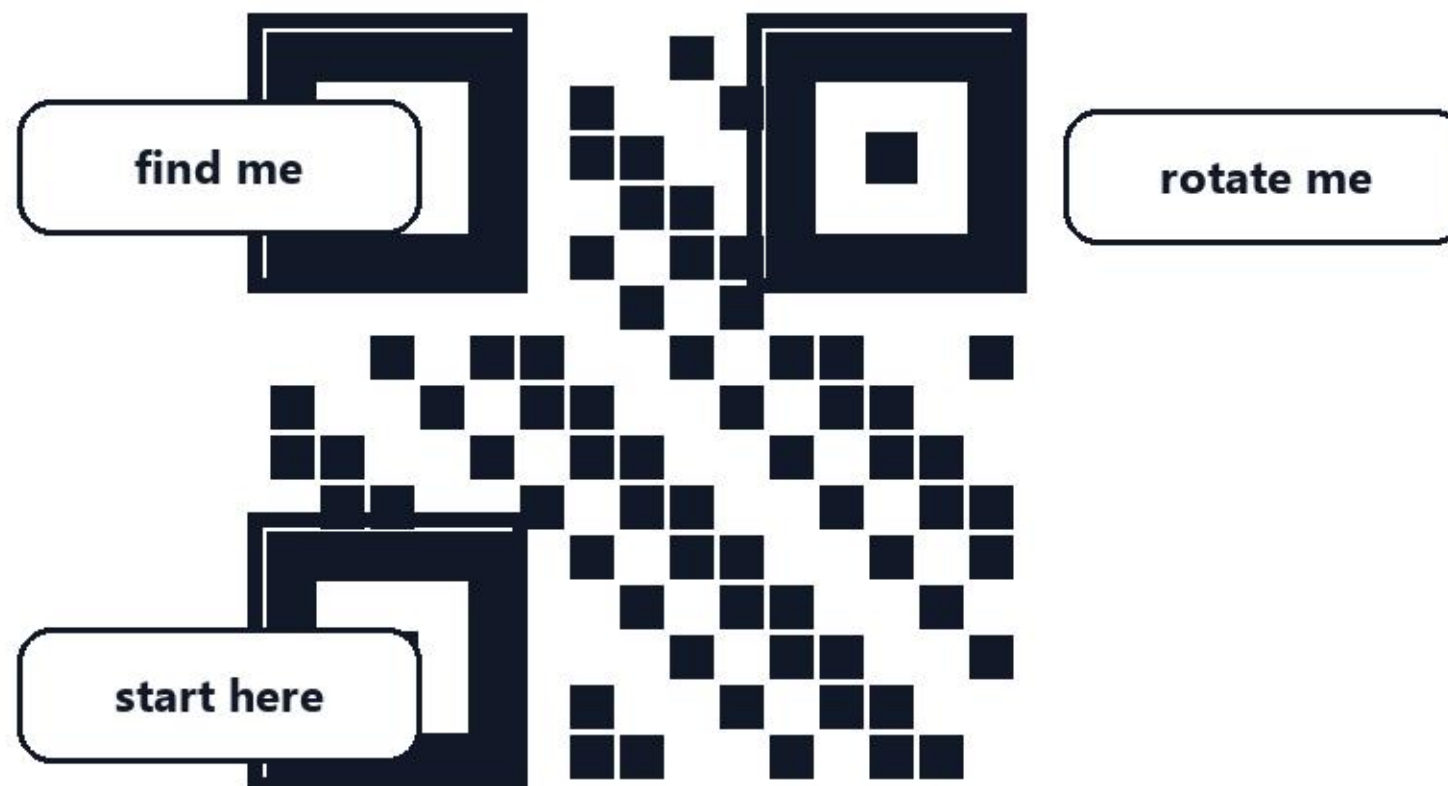
**A code is only useful if the machine can find it fast
on a messy printed surface.**

The second clue came from a train window.



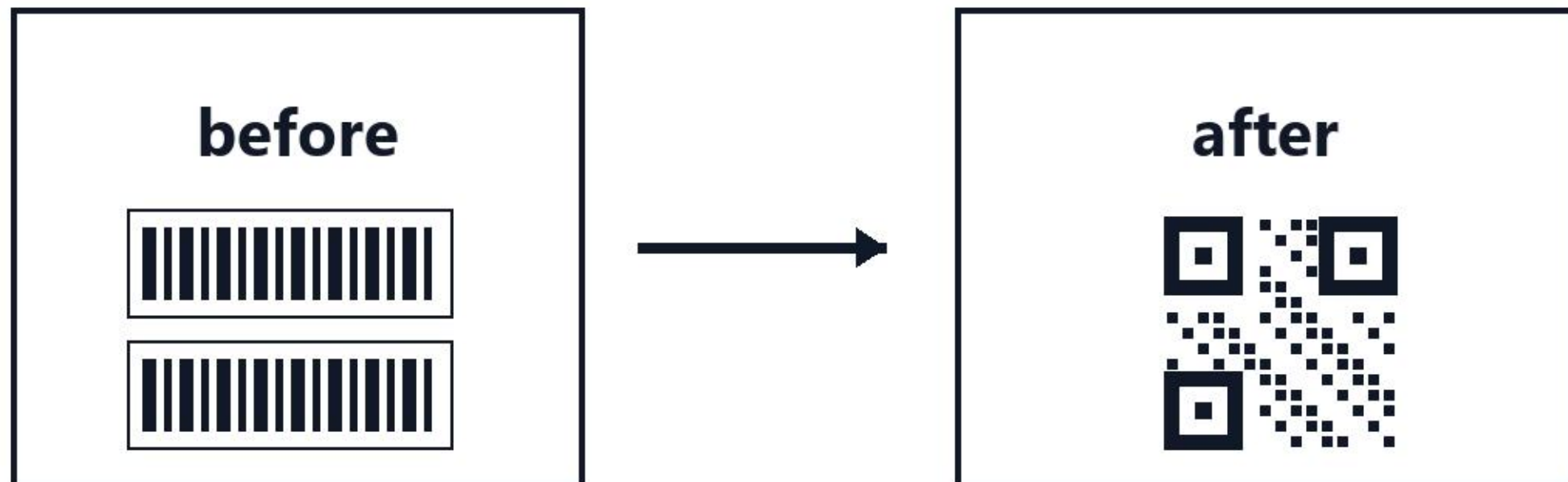
A distinctive pattern in building windows helped point toward a locator symbol that would stand out.

Those three big squares are not decoration.



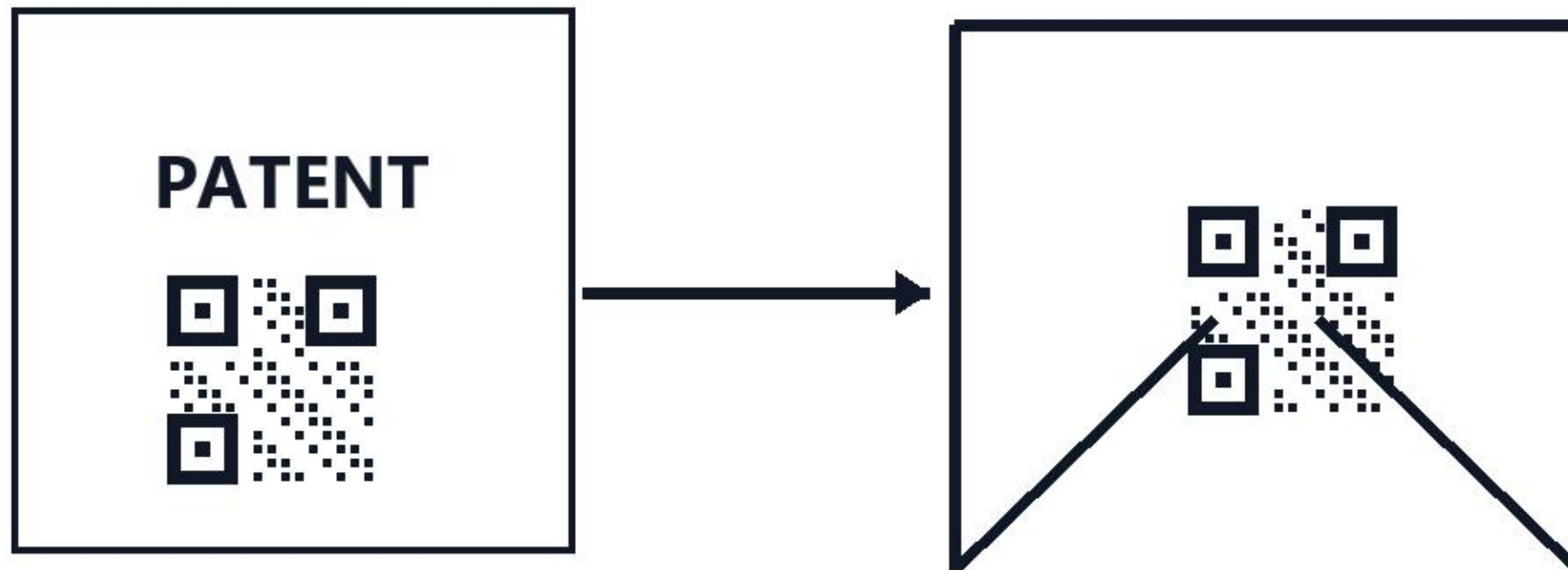
**The finder patterns tell the scanner where the code is,
how it is rotated, and where to start.**

In 1994, DENSO WAVE released the QR Code.



**QR meant Quick Response.
Very literal naming. Refreshing, honestly.**

Decision: let people use it. **FOR FREE!!!**



**DENSO retained patent rights, but chose not to enforce them.
That open strategy helped the format spread.**

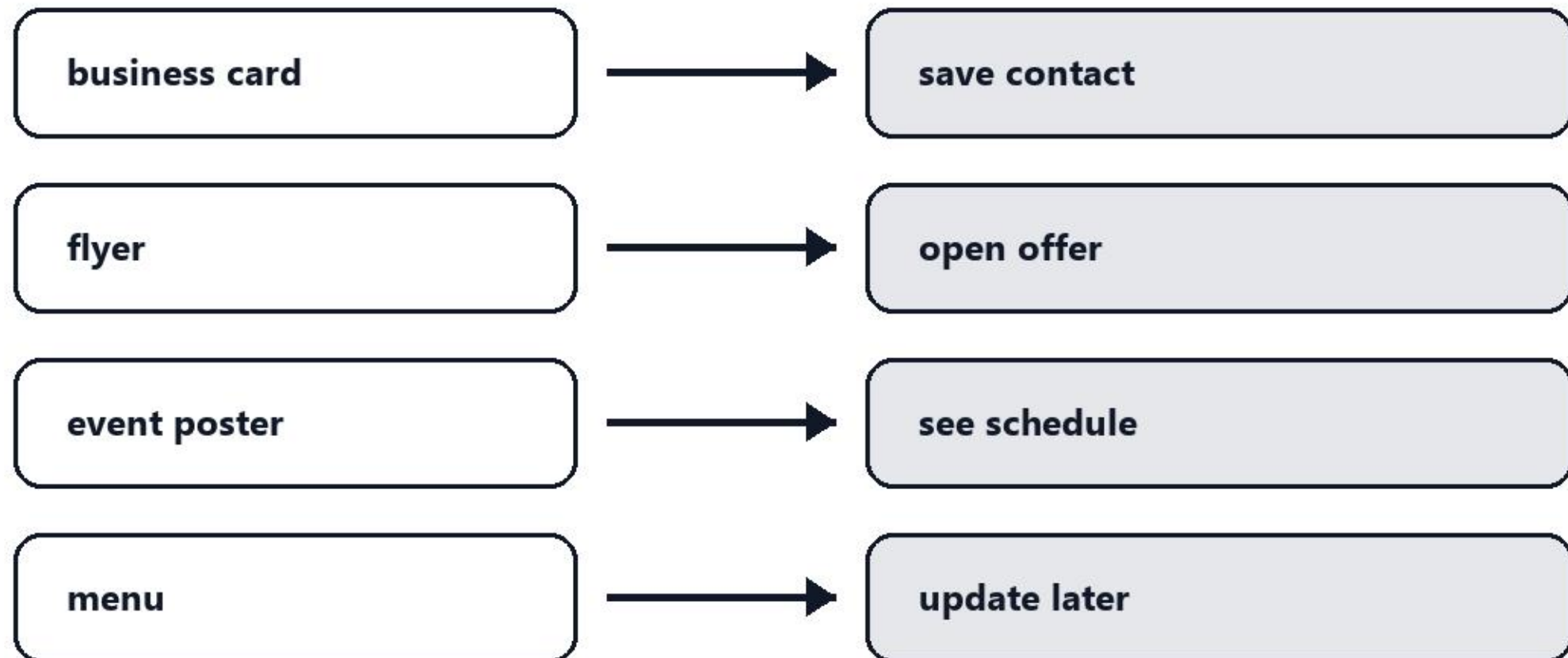
The invention had to wait for the world to catch up.



**The QR code was invented in 1994.
Most people needed phones and new habits before it felt normal.**

A QR code is not the campaign.

It is the handoff.



**The original job was physical object to digital information.
Good marketing uses the same handoff.**

Sources / References

- DENSO WAVE: QR Code history and development story
- QRcode.com: History of QR Code
- Japan Patent Office: QR Code patent and finder-pattern explanation
- The Guardian interview with Masahiro Hara
- Unsung Science interview/transcript with Masahiro Hara
- IEEE Spectrum: Go board and building inspiration summary
- DENSO WAVE / QR Code official site: 1994 release and Quick Response naming

Comic-style dramatization. Technical claims sourced above; dialogue and scenes are reconstructed for storytelling.